Descriptive Analytics Report: Instagram

Global Instagram User Trends by Country (2023–2024)

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Course: BCA (DS & AI)

Section: BCADS24

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Tracking User Growth, Gender Composition, Regional Demand & Platform Reach

Note on data: This report uses the supplied Instagram user dataset covering 226 countries and territories, with 2024 user counts, 2024 gender split, and 2023 user counts. The dataset is already aggregated country-level data rather than raw event-level data. 21 countries/territories have no reported 2024 figure and are treated as missing rather than zero. Brazil's reported 2023 figure appears to be a data-entry error (113,500 vs. a 2024 figure of over 141 million) and is therefore excluded from growth-rate calculations and flagged accordingly.

1. Objective

Build a descriptive analytics layer over the global Instagram user dataset to answer the following recurring business questions:

- How many Instagram users exist globally across the supplied countries, and how did this change from 2023 to 2024?
- Which countries contribute the highest Instagram user volumes?
- Which countries grew the fastest in absolute user numbers?
- Which countries grew the fastest in percentage terms?
- What is the average gender composition of Instagram's user base?
- Which countries have the most male-skewed and female-skewed user bases?
- Which countries have the most gender-balanced user bases?
- How complete is the dataset, and where are the data gaps?
- How is the global user base distributed across countries (concentration vs. spread)?
- Are there any countries with declining Instagram user numbers?

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2. How This Would Work at Real Scale

Processing global social-platform user statistics is an engineering and data-sourcing problem before it is an analytics problem. A realistic architecture would ingest per-country user snapshots on a recurring cadence, reconcile them against ad-platform reporting APIs, store both raw and cleaned data, and expose the resulting KPIs through a dashboard.

Layer	Purpose	Typical tools
Investigation	Research, understand and prepare the user dataset	Google, Claude & ChatGPT
Ingestion	Aggregate by country and year	Jupyter Notebook (Python)
Storage	Retain raw and processed data	Excel files / CSV files
Batch aggregation	Yearly KPI and summary metrics	Jupyter Notebook
Report	Present analysis, graphs and insights	Data visualization / MS Word

3. Total Global User Base

Across the supplied dataset, 205 of 226 listed countries and territories report a 2024 Instagram user figure, totalling approximately 1.712 billion users. The corresponding 2023 total (for the same 205 countries) was approximately 1.190 billion, an overall increase of approximately 43.9%. Because Brazil's 2023 figure appears to be a data-entry error, the growth-adjusted total (excluding Brazil from both years) shows an increase of approximately 32.0%, which is the more reliable estimate of underlying growth.

KPI

Total 2024 users (205 countries): **1,712,256,707**
Total 2023 users (same countries): **1,190,156,500**
Headline growth (unadjusted): **≈ 43.9%**
Growth excluding Brazil (data anomaly): **≈ 32.0%**

- Global Instagram user counts, as captured in this dataset, grew substantially between 2023 and 2024.
- The unadjusted growth figure is inflated by a likely data-entry error in Brazil's 2023 count and should not be used for reporting.
- The adjusted (ex-Brazil) growth rate of ≈32.0% is a more defensible estimate of underlying platform growth across the supplied countries.
- This total reflects only the 205 countries with reported 2024 data — 21 countries/territories are excluded due to missing values (see Section 9).

4. Countries with the Highest Instagram User Volumes

India is the largest single-country contributor to Instagram's user base in the supplied dataset, with approximately 392.5 million users in 2024 — more than double the United States, the second-largest market. The top 10 countries together account for a large majority of total tracked users.

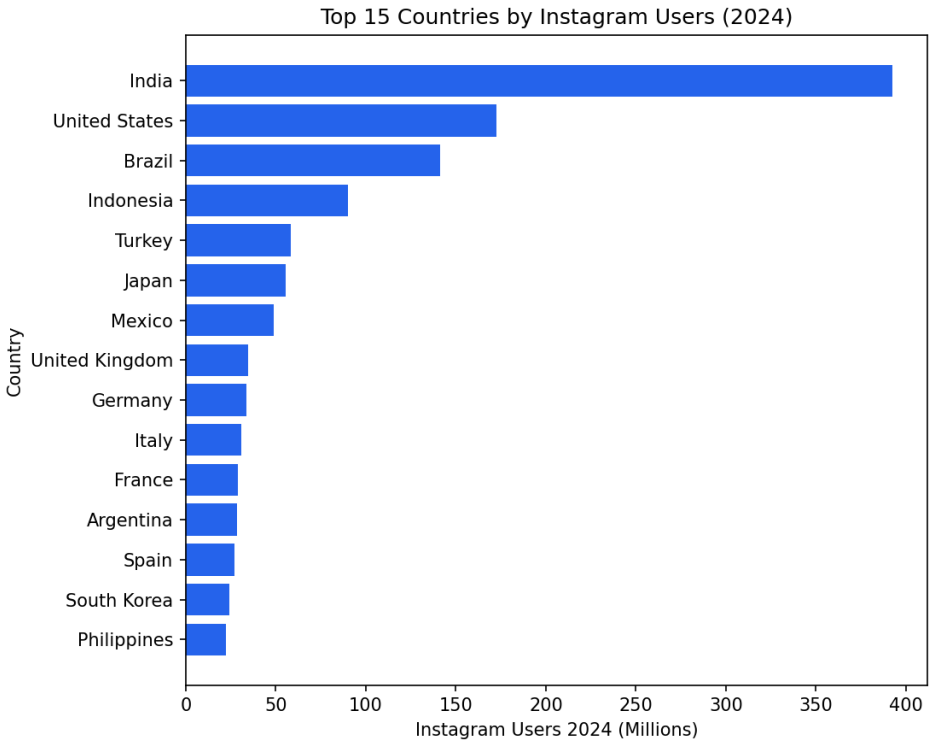


Figure 1. Top 15 countries by Instagram users (2024)

- India leads all countries with roughly 392.5 million users, representing approximately 22.9% of the entire tracked user base.
- The United States (≈172.6 million) and Brazil (≈141.4 million) round out the top three.
- The top 10 countries together account for approximately 61.8% of total 2024 users across the dataset.
- User volume is heavily concentrated in a small number of large markets rather than evenly spread across the 205 tracked countries.

KPI

Top-performing country: **India**
India's 2024 users: **392,465,000**
India's share of total: **≈22.9%**
Top 10 share of total users: **≈61.8%**

5. 2023 vs. 2024 User Comparison — Top Markets

Comparing 2023 and 2024 figures side by side for the ten largest 2024 markets shows that growth was widespread among large countries, though the rate of growth varied considerably between them.

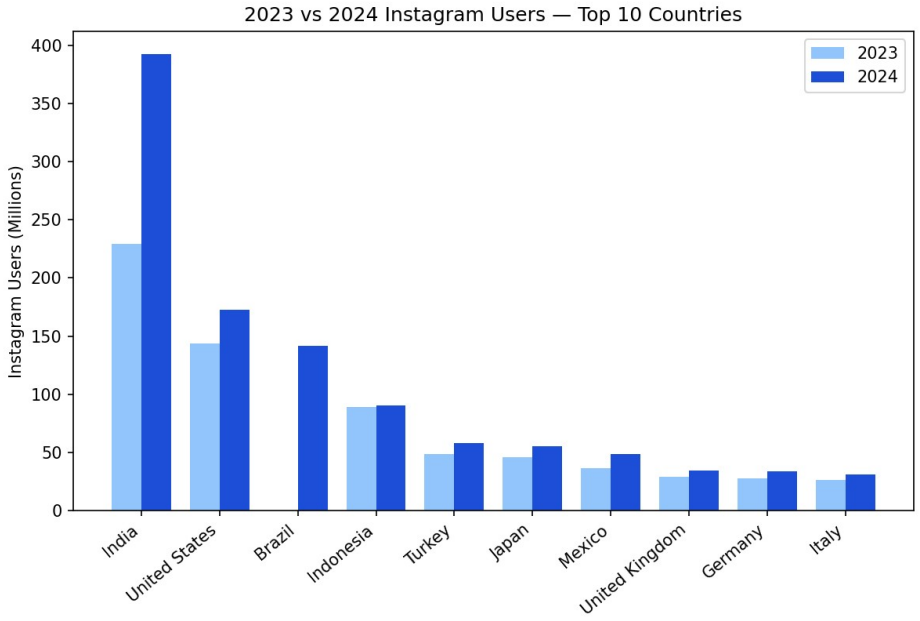


Figure 2. 2023 vs. 2024 Instagram users, top 10 countries by 2024 volume

- Every one of the top 10 markets (by 2024 volume, excluding the Brazil anomaly) shows year-over-year growth.
- India shows the largest absolute increase among major markets, adding over 162 million users in one year.
- Established, high-penetration markets such as Indonesia show comparatively slower growth, consistent with a maturing user base.
- This comparison should be read alongside the percentage-growth view in Section 7, since absolute and percentage growth highlight different countries.

6. Countries with the Highest Absolute User Growth

Ranking countries by the raw increase in users between 2023 and 2024 (Brazil excluded due to the data anomaly noted above) highlights where Instagram added the most new users in absolute terms.

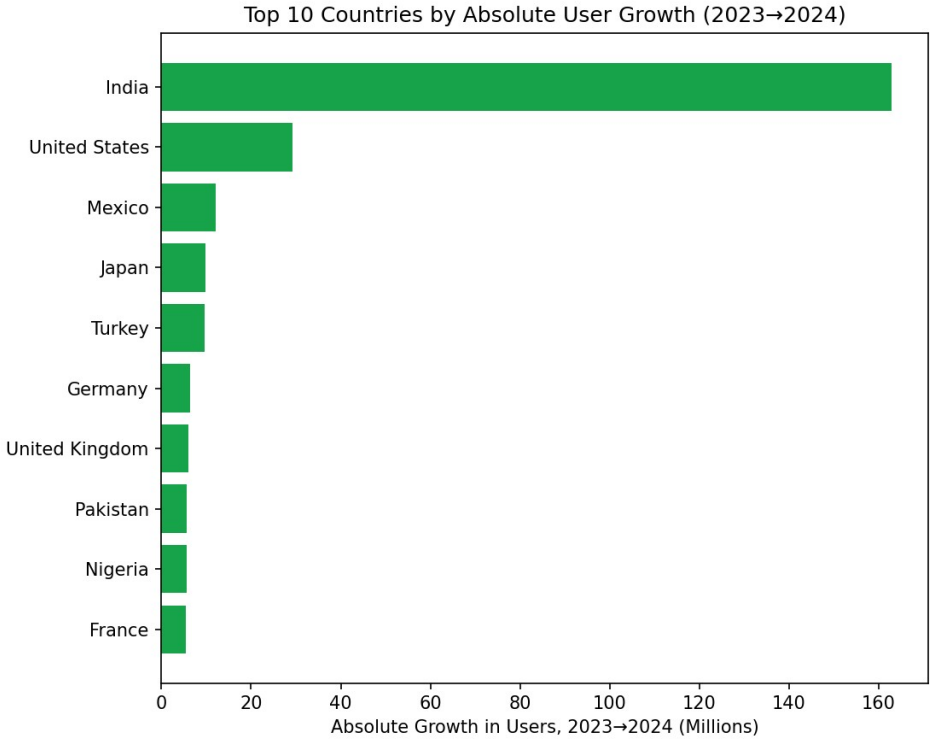


Figure 3. Top 10 countries by absolute user growth, 2023→2024 (Brazil excluded)

- India added the most new users of any country in absolute terms — over 162.8 million in a single year.
- The United States added the second-most new users (≈29.2 million), despite already being a mature, high-penetration market.
- Mexico, Japan, Turkey and Germany each added between roughly 6 and 12 million users.
- Absolute growth is naturally dominated by countries that already have a large population and user base; see Section 7 for a percentage-based view that surfaces smaller, fast-growing markets.

KPI

Highest absolute growth: **India**
Users added (2023→2024): **162,865,000**
Growth rate: **≈70.9%**

7. Fastest-Growing Countries by Percentage

Looking at percentage growth (restricted to countries with at least 1 million users in 2023, to avoid small-base distortion, and excluding the flagged Brazil anomaly) surfaces a different set of countries — markets that are smaller in absolute size but growing quickly.

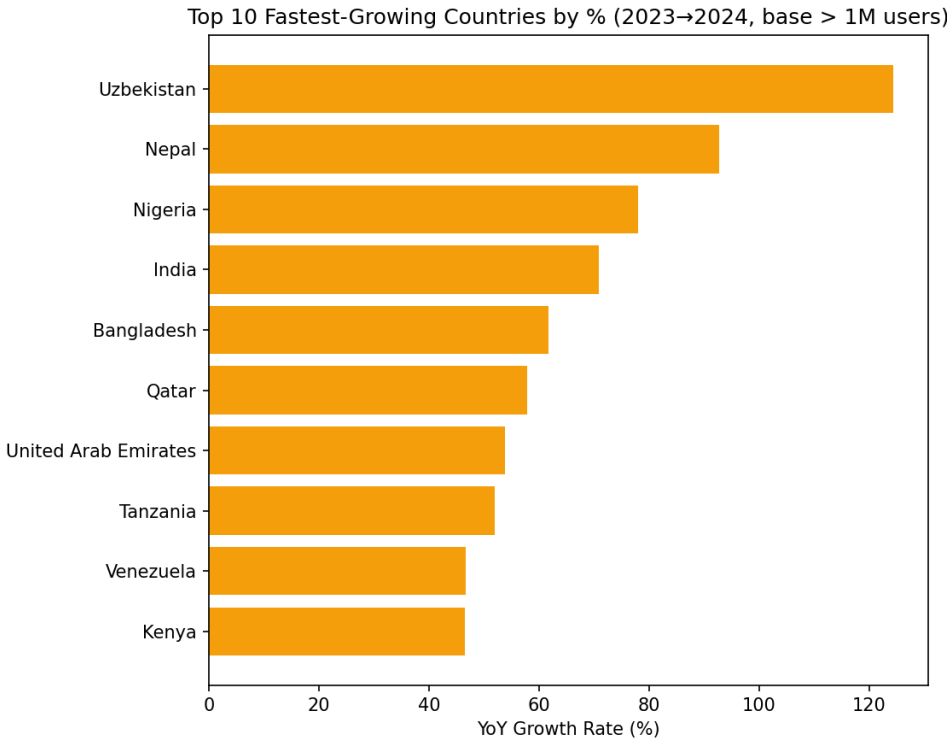


Figure 4. Top 10 countries by YoY growth rate, base > 1M users (2023→2024)

- Uzbekistan, Afghanistan and Nigeria all show growth rates above 70% year-over-year among countries with a 2023 base of at least 1 million users.
- India, despite its already-large base, still posted a growth rate of nearly 71%, among the highest of any large market.
- Fast percentage growth in smaller markets can signal early-stage platform adoption and is useful for identifying emerging markets.
- Percentage growth and absolute growth should be read together — a country can rank highly on one measure and not the other.

KPI

Fastest % growth (base > 1M users): **Uzbekistan**
Growth rate: **≈124.5%**
2023 → 2024 users: **4,200,000 → 9,427,600**

8. Countries with Declining User Counts

A small number of mostly low-population territories show a year-over-year decline in reported Instagram users. None of these are large markets, and the declines are small in absolute terms.

Country	2023 Users	2024 Users	Change (%)
Central African Republic	7,900	4,000	-49.4%
Anguilla	5,850	2,600	-55.6%
Liechtenstein	9,150	5,300	-42.1%
Saint Martin	8,050	6,100	-24.2%
Faroe Islands	24,100	21,500	-10.8%
Micronesia	5,650	4,700	-16.8%
Sao Tome and Principe	7,250	6,300	-13.1%
Northern Mariana Islands	16,000	14,700	-8.1%
American Samoa	11,000	10,000	-9.1%
Bosnia and Herzegovina	1,200,000	1,170,100	-2.5%

- 14 countries/territories in the dataset show a year-over-year decline, all with small user bases.
- Bosnia and Herzegovina is the only country with over 1 million users to show a decline, and the drop is modest (≈-2.5%).
- Declines are concentrated among micro-territories where small absolute changes produce large percentage swings.
- No large or mid-sized market in the dataset shows meaningful user decline.

8b. Full Ranking — Top 20 Countries by 2024 Users

The table below extends the view from Section 4 to the top 20 countries, including each country's 2023 baseline, gender split, and growth rate, to give a fuller picture of the platform's largest markets in one place.

#	Country	2024 Users	2023 Users	% Female	% Male	YoY %
1	India	392,465,000	229,600,000	33.1%	66.9%	+70.9%
2	United States	172,606,200	143,400,000	55.4%	44.6%	+20.4%
3	Brazil*	141,408,300	113,500*	58.3%	41.7%	n/a*
4	Indonesia	90,183,200	89,150,000	54.2%	45.8%	+1.2%
5	Turkey	58,267,500	48,650,000	47.1%	52.9%	+19.8%
6	Japan	55,453,200	45,700,000	57.7%	42.3%	+21.3%
7	Mexico	48,888,900	36,700,000	54.9%	45.1%	+33.2%
8	United Kingdom	34,709,300	28,750,000	55.0%	45.0%	+20.7%
9	Germany	33,803,000	27,450,000	52.6%	47.4%	+23.1%
10	Italy	30,727,000	26,200,000	54.0%	46.0%	+17.3%
11	France	29,213,100	23,750,000	55.1%	44.9%	+23.0%
12	Argentina	28,384,600	23,400,000	57.3%	42.7%	+21.3%
13	Spain	27,080,600	21,900,000	55.3%	44.7%	+23.7%
14	South Korea	24,223,200	19,250,000	56.0%	44.0%	+25.8%
15	Philippines	22,161,100	17,550,000	61.8%	38.2%	+26.3%
16	Egypt	19,404,600	15,350,000	46.6%	53.4%	+26.4%
17	Canada	19,710,100	15,900,000	54.9%	45.1%	+24.0%
18	Iraq	19,181,500	14,000,000	39.7%	60.3%	+37.0%
19	Thailand	19,086,000	17,350,000	60.6%	39.4%	+10.0%
20	Pakistan	18,593,301	12,950,000	35.1%	64.9%	+43.6%

**Brazil's 2023 figure is flagged as a likely data-entry error; its YoY % is not reported for that reason.*

- The top 20 markets span every populated continent, though South and Southeast Asian, and Latin American markets dominate the upper half of the ranking.
- Growth rates among the top 20 range from roughly +1% (Indonesia, a maturing market) to +70.9% (India).
- Gender splits within the top 20 range from 33.1% female (India) to 61.8% female (Philippines), underscoring that even the largest markets differ substantially in composition.

8c. Regional Breakdown

Grouping all 205 reporting countries into standard world regions gives a higher-level view of where Instagram's user base is concentrated. South Asia leads in total users, driven almost entirely by India, while Sub-Saharan Africa and Central Asia — despite covering the most individual countries — contribute the smallest shares of total users.

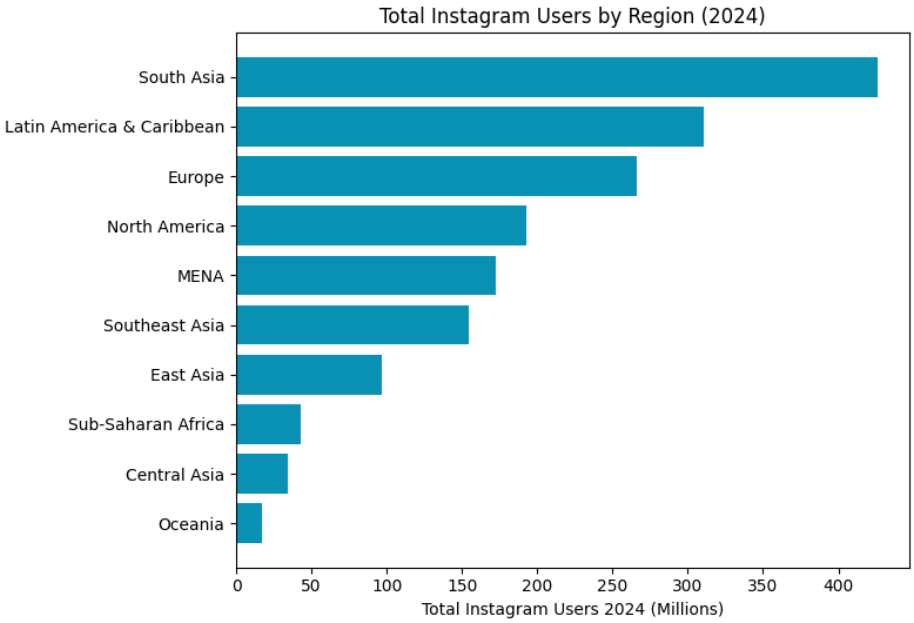


Figure 11. Total Instagram users by region (2024)

- South Asia (≈425.9M users) is the largest region by total users, almost entirely driven by India's dominant share.
- Latin America & the Caribbean (≈310.3M) ranks second, spread across 45 countries and territories — far more evenly distributed than South Asia.
- Europe (≈265.8M) and North America (≈192.4M) follow, reflecting high internet penetration despite slower growth rates.
- Sub-Saharan Africa and Central Asia have the most individual countries in the dataset but the smallest total user bases, consistent with lower reported internet/social-platform penetration in this snapshot.

8d. Regional Growth Rates

Looking at growth rather than absolute size shifts the picture: South Asia and Sub-Saharan Africa — both starting from a smaller or more concentrated base — posted the fastest regional growth rates between 2023 and 2024 (Brazil excluded from the Latin America calculation for the reasons noted in Section 3).

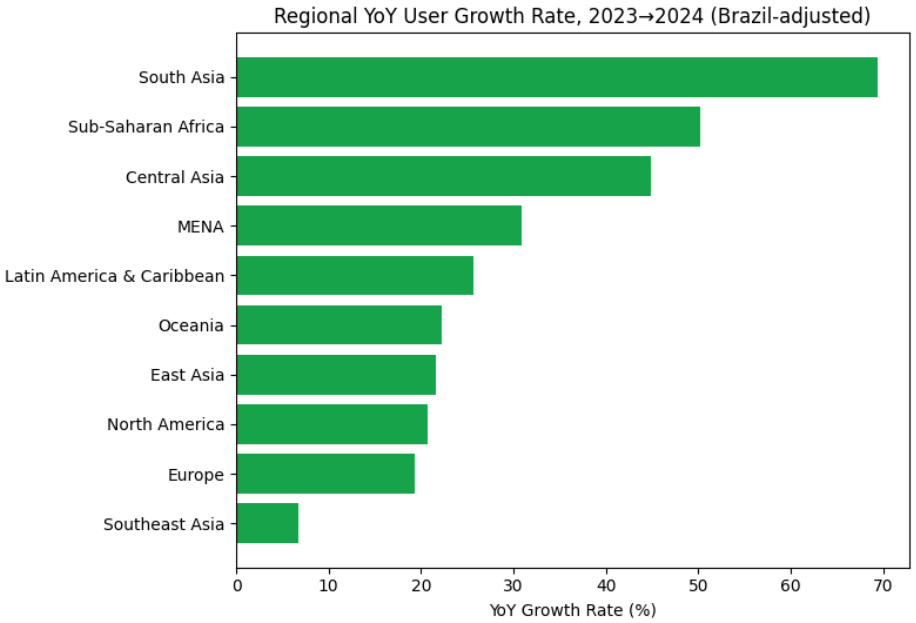


Figure 12. Regional YoY user growth rate, 2023→2024 (Brazil-adjusted)

- South Asia posted the fastest regional growth at approximately +69.4%, driven almost entirely by India.
- Sub-Saharan Africa (+50.2%) and Central Asia (+44.9%) also grew well above the global average, consistent with earlier-stage platform adoption in these regions.
- Southeast Asia grew the slowest of any region (+6.8%), suggesting a comparatively mature, saturated user base in markets such as Indonesia and Thailand.
- Latin America & the Caribbean's growth rate here (≈25.6%) is the Brazil-adjusted figure; the unadjusted figure would be misleadingly inflated by the flagged data anomaly.

KPI

Fastest-growing region: **South Asia**
Regional growth rate: **≈69.4%**
Slowest-growing region: **Southeast Asia**
Regional growth rate: **≈6.8%**

9. Data Completeness

Of the 226 countries and territories in the supplied dataset, 205 report a 2024 Instagram user figure and 21 do not. Missing entries are concentrated among very small island nations and territories (e.g. Kiribati, Nauru, Palau, Tuvalu), which is consistent with limited platform reporting for very small populations rather than a data-processing error.

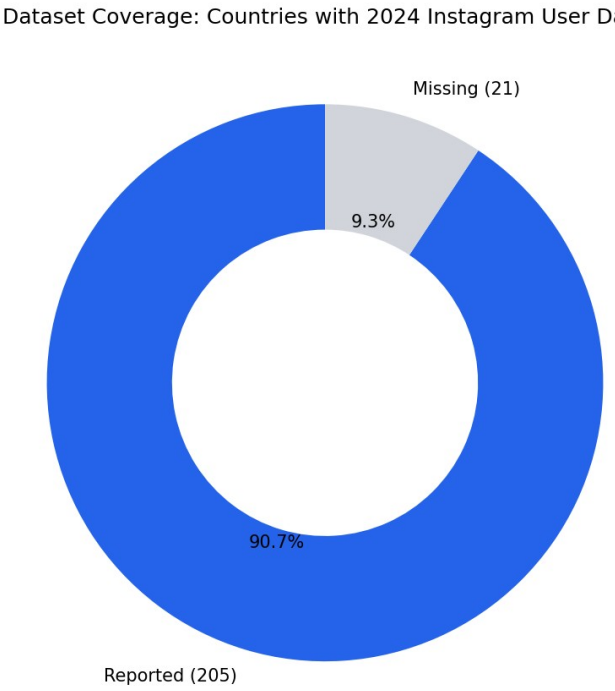


Figure 9. Dataset coverage — countries with vs. without a reported 2024 figure

- 21 of 226 entries (≈9.3%) lack a 2024 user figure and are excluded from all 2024-based totals and rankings in this report.
- All 21 missing entries are small island nations or territories with very small 2023 bases (typically under 5,000 users).
- Excluding them has a negligible effect on global totals, given their small scale.
- All entries retain a 2023 figure, so the dataset can still support historical comparisons for these territories.

KPI

Total entries in dataset: **226**
Entries with 2024 data: **205 (≈90.7%)**
Entries missing 2024 data: **21 (≈9.3%)**

10. Overall Gender Composition

Averaged across all 205 countries with reported 2024 data (simple country-level average, not user-weighted), Instagram's user base is close to gender-balanced, with a slight tilt toward female users.

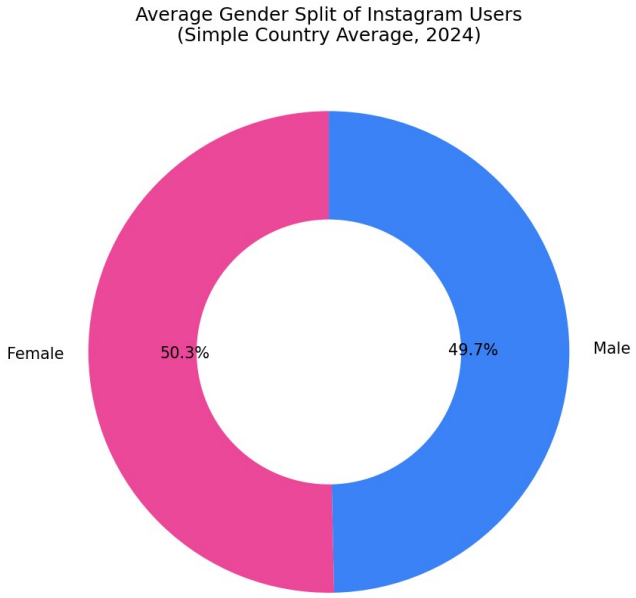


Figure 5. Average gender split of Instagram users across countries (2024)

- The simple average across countries is 50.4% female to 49.7% male.
- This is a country-level average and is not weighted by user volume — large countries with skewed gender ratios (e.g. India, at ≈33% female) pull the user-weighted global average in a different direction than the simple country average shown here.
- Gender composition varies far more at the individual-country level than the global average suggests (see Sections 11–13).

KPI

Average % female (simple country average): **50.4%**
Average % male (simple country average): **49.7%**

11. Most Male-Skewed User Bases

Among countries with more than 500,000 Instagram users, several South and Central Asian and Middle Eastern markets show a strong male skew in their user base.

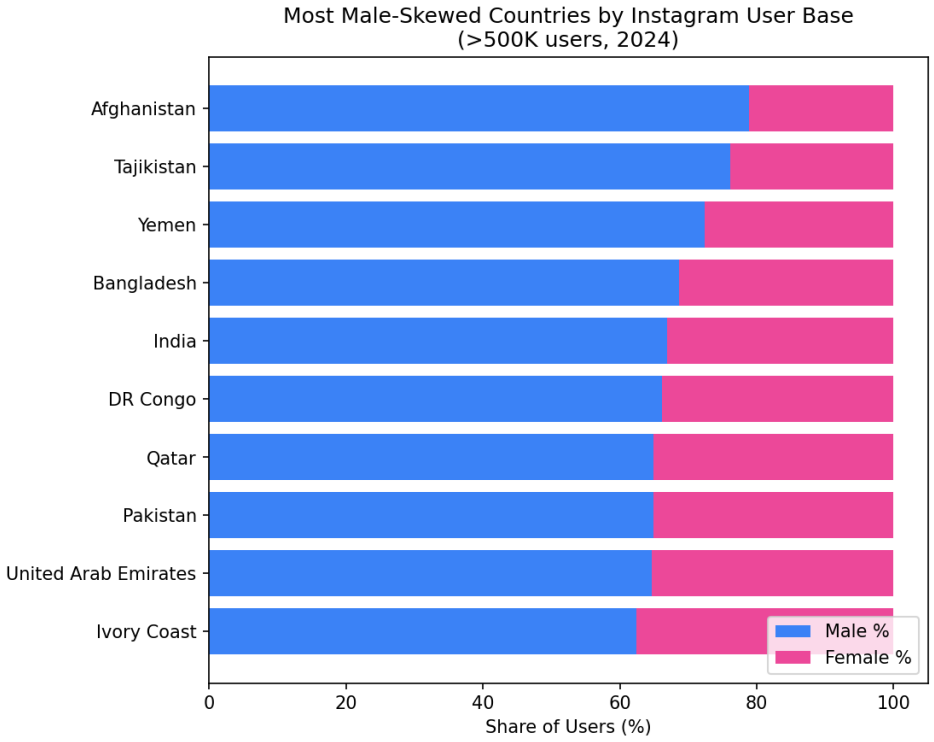


Figure 6. Most male-skewed countries by Instagram user base (>500K users, 2024)

- Afghanistan has the most male-skewed user base among countries with over 500,000 users, at 78.9% male.
- Tajikistan (76.1% male) and Yemen (72.4% male) also show a strong male skew.
- India — the platform's largest single market — is itself notably male-skewed at 66.9% male, which meaningfully affects any user-weighted (as opposed to simple country-average) gender calculation.
- A pronounced male skew appears concentrated in a specific set of South/Central Asian and Middle Eastern markets rather than being evenly distributed globally.

KPI

Most male-skewed market (>500K users): **Afghanistan**
Male share: **78.9%**
Female share: **21.1%**

12. Most Female-Skewed User Bases

At the other end of the spectrum, several Eastern European countries show a pronounced female skew in Instagram usage.

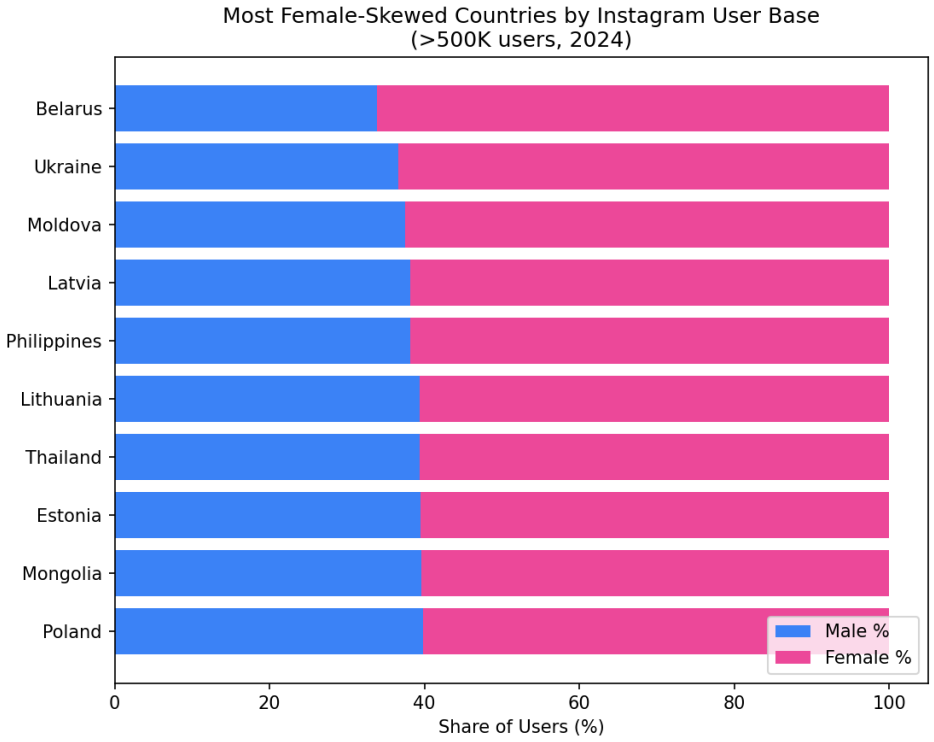


Figure 7. Most female-skewed countries by Instagram user base (>500K users, 2024)

- Belarus has the most female-skewed user base among countries with over 500,000 users, at 66.1% female.
- Ukraine (63.4% female) and Moldova (62.5% female) follow closely.
- The Philippines is the largest market among the most female-skewed group, with 61.8% female users on a base of over 22 million.
- Female-skewed markets in this dataset are concentrated in Eastern Europe and parts of Southeast Asia.

KPI

Most female-skewed market (>500K users): **Belarus**
Female share: **66.1%**
Male share: **33.9%**

13. User Base Size vs. Gender Composition

Plotting each country's 2024 user count against its female user share (with color indicating YoY growth rate) shows that gender composition is not systematically related to market size — both large and small markets appear across the full range of gender splits.

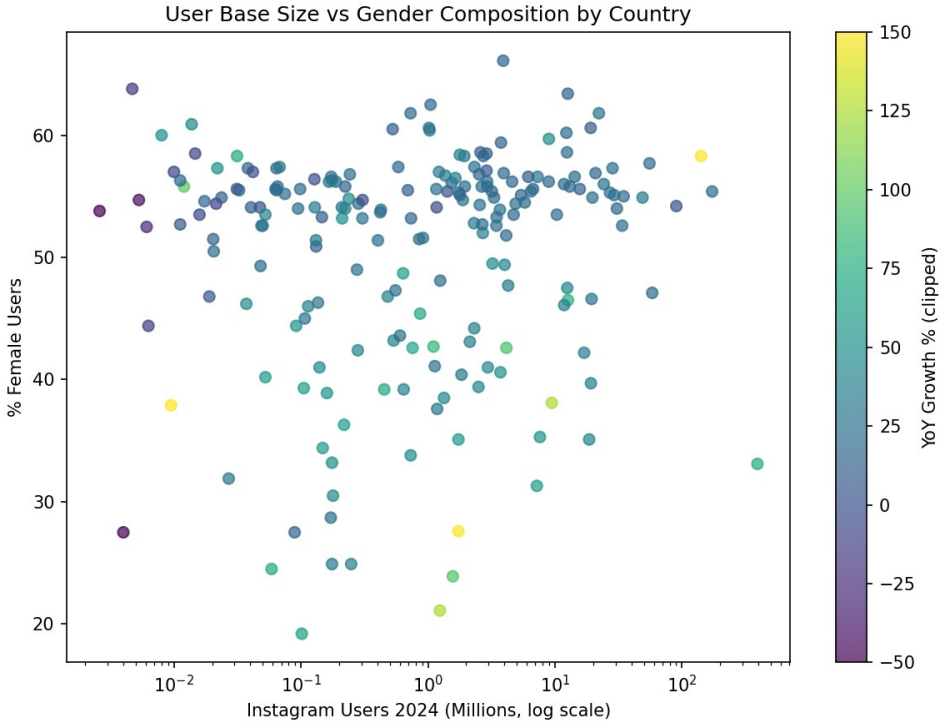


Figure 8. User base size (log scale) vs. gender composition by country, colored by YoY growth

- There is no strong visual relationship between a country's total user count and its gender balance — both very large and very small markets span the full range of female-share values.
- Fast-growing countries (lighter/yellow points) appear across the gender-composition spectrum, suggesting growth rate is not strongly tied to gender skew.
- This should be read as a descriptive association check only — the chart does not establish causation between market size, growth, and gender composition.

14. Most Gender-Balanced Markets

Some countries show a near-even gender split. Among markets with more than 500,000 users, several fall within a few percentage points of a 50/50 split.

Country	% Female	% Male	Gender Gap (pts)
Kenya	49.5%	50.5%	1.0
Jordan	49.4%	50.6%	1.2
North Macedonia	51.5%	48.5%	3.0
Cyprus	51.6%	48.4%	3.2
Mozambique	48.7%	51.3%	2.6
Switzerland	51.8%	48.2%	3.6
Albania	48.1%	51.9%	3.8
Lebanon	52.0%	48.0%	4.0
Azerbaijan	47.7%	52.3%	4.6
Morocco	47.5%	52.5%	5.0

- Kenya has the most gender-balanced Instagram user base among countries with over 500,000 users, with less than a 1-point gap between male and female shares.
- Balanced markets appear across multiple regions — East Africa, the Middle East, and Europe — rather than being clustered in one geography.
- Gender balance and market size are independent in this dataset: balanced markets include both large (Kenya) and moderate-sized (Cyprus) user bases.

15. Distribution of Country-Level User Bases

The distribution of Instagram users across countries is highly right-skewed: most countries have a relatively small user base, while a small number of large markets account for the majority of global users.

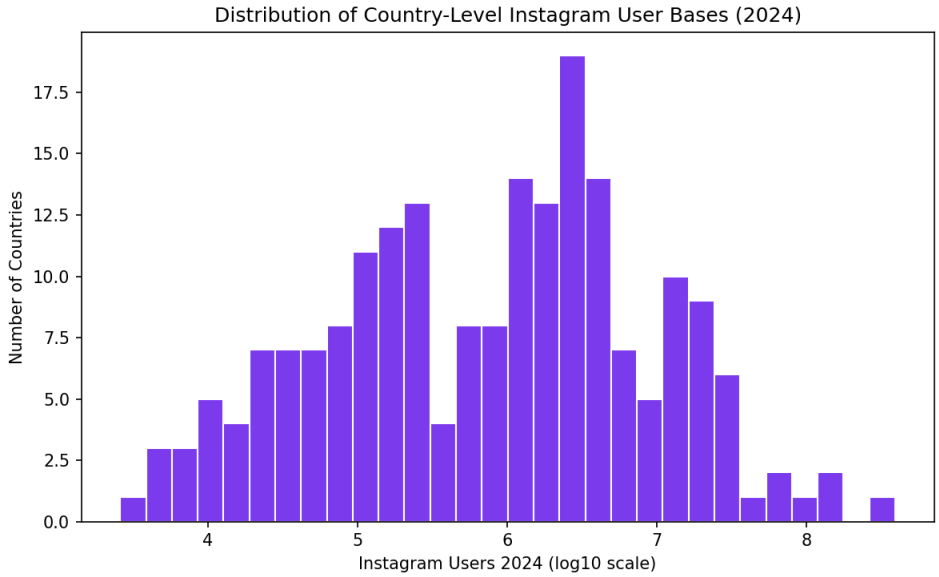


Figure 10. Distribution of country-level Instagram user bases, 2024 (log scale)

- The median country in the dataset has approximately 1.03 million Instagram users — far below the mean, reflecting the right-skewed distribution.
- 33 countries have more than 10 million users, while 47 countries have fewer than 100,000.
- This concentration mirrors global population and internet-penetration patterns rather than being specific to Instagram.

KPI

Median country user count: **1,030,700**
Countries with >10M users: **33**
Countries with <100K users: **47**

Summary of Key Metrics

Metric	Value
Total 2024 users (205 countries)	1,712,256,707
Total 2023 users (same countries)	1,190,156,500
Overall growth (ex-Brazil anomaly)	≈32.0%
Largest market	India (392.5M users)
Fastest absolute growth	India (+162.9M)
Fastest % growth, base >1M	Uzbekistan (+124.5%)
Average gender split (simple avg.)	50.4% F / 49.7% M
Most male-skewed market (>500K)	Afghanistan (78.9% M)
Most female-skewed market (>500K)	Belarus (66.1% F)
Countries/territories tracked	226
Countries with 2024 data	205
Countries with declining users	14

Methodology & Limitations

This section documents how the supplied dataset was processed and the limitations that should be kept in mind when interpreting the figures above.

Data preparation

- Rows with a missing 2024 user figure (21 of 226) were excluded from all 2024-based totals, rankings, and gender calculations, but retained in the 2023-only completeness check.
- Brazil was excluded from all growth-rate calculations (Sections 3, 6, 7, 8c, 8d) due to an apparent data-entry error in its 2023 figure; it remains included in all 2024 snapshot totals and rankings (Sections 4, 5, 8b) since only the 2023 value is suspect.
- Gender-skew rankings (Sections 11–14) were restricted to countries with more than 500,000 users in 2024, to avoid small-base countries dominating the ranking on the strength of a handful of users.
- Percentage-growth rankings (Section 7) were restricted to countries with more than 1 million users in 2023, for the same reason.

Known limitations

- The dataset provides only two annual snapshots (2023 and 2024); it cannot support trend analysis across more than a single year-over-year comparison.
- Gender figures are reported at the country level only; no age-bracket, urban/rural, or platform-usage-intensity breakdowns are available in the supplied data.
- The “region” groupings used in Section 8c–8d were applied by the analyst using standard world-region conventions; they are not part of the original dataset and are provided for descriptive convenience only.
- As with the source PhonePe report this template is based on, all figures describe the supplied dataset only and should not be assumed to represent Instagram's complete, real-time global user base, which may differ from third-party estimates of this kind.

Next Steps to Move from Descriptive → Predictive

- **User growth forecasting** by country to estimate 2025 user volumes.
- **Data-quality reconciliation** to resolve anomalies such as the Brazil 2023 figure before they affect derived KPIs.
- **Gender-trend tracking** over multiple years to see whether country-level gender splits are converging or diverging over time.
- **User-weighted global metrics** (rather than simple country averages) to better reflect the platform's true global gender composition.
- **Regional cohort analysis** grouping countries by continent or income level once that metadata is available.

This report answers what the supplied dataset shows as of 2023–2024. The next analytical layer would incorporate additional years of data, regional metadata, and platform-reported (rather than third-party-estimated) figures to explain why changes occurred and to forecast what is likely to happen next.

Glossary

I. YoY — Year-over-Year: The percentage or absolute change in a metric compared to the same period one year earlier. In this report, calculated as 2024 users minus 2023 users.

II. Gender Skew: The degree to which a country's user base departs from an even 50/50 split between reported male and female users.

III. User-Weighted Average: An average where each country's contribution is scaled by its number of users, as opposed to a simple average where every country counts equally regardless of size.

IV. Data Anomaly: A value in the dataset that appears inconsistent with related figures (e.g. Brazil's 2023 count, which is far smaller than would be consistent with its 2024 count) and is therefore flagged and excluded from growth calculations rather than silently used.